

“ Developers play a key role in bringing about digital literacy ”



Narendra Bhandari, director, Intel Software and Services Group, Intel South Asia

Q Do you feel India is rich enough in open source skills when compared to the other markets?

Yes. As we see more platforms getting deployed and business models evolving in the software community, one can say that India is definitely offering the right kind of talent. Around 3-5 years ago, software was largely sold on a licence basis. Today things have changed. Software for content or a service is sold to a consumer in many different forms. Open source is definitely one component that has contributed to this process. The consumerisation of applications has also contributed to this changing business model in a pretty significant way. There is a lot of contribution from India from the applications perspective. All these developments lead to the conclusion that the awareness and contributions from the Indian developers' community are growing. I don't know how to measure this but I can see a significant change in the way contributions have gone up from the Indian territory. India is certainly rich in open source talent.

Intel is one of the biggest contributors to open source technology, which also makes the company one of the biggest recruiters of open source professionals. The company has a lot of initiatives involving developers. So anyone with the 'right' skill-set can think of working with this technology major. **Diksha P Gupta** from *Open Source For You* spoke to **Narendra Bhandari**, director, *Intel Software and Services Group, Intel South Asia*, to understand the company's recruitment strategy with respect to open source developers. Excerpts...

Q Is this one of the reasons why Intel is eyeing the Indian market for open source technology?

If you've observed our behaviour, we have almost continuously invested in India over the last five to seven years and worked with companies to build solutions for multiple platforms. We have been working with the developers, because the devices are growing in the market and the availability of broadband is also continuously growing. Our fundamental approach is to drive digital literacy in every home in the country, if possible. That will happen through devices and connectivity, amongst other things. The way Intel wants to address this is by getting more and more relevant applications. That will drive technology usage and digital literacy, and attract more users. Look at it in this way—a couple of years back, one could not think of booking air tickets sitting in the remotest parts of the country, but it is possible now. To answer your question about why we continuously work with the developers, my answer would be: to drive digital literacy and that will mostly come through applications. And applications come from developers. If you look at the entire eco-system, our role will be to continuously invest, incentivise and educate developers to build more applications relevant for our lives. So developers play a key role in bringing about digital literacy.

Q Since Intel's thrust is on open source technology, do you think that there has been a surge in the demand for open source professionals in the past few years, particularly in the Indian market?